Field manual for survey teams

Segmenting the cluster, selecting households, interviewing and verifying records

Independent NDD Coverage Evaluation Survey, Madhya Pradesh, November 2026

AIIMS Bhopal with the Community Medicine departments of Khandwa, Chhindwara, Ratlam and Shahdol medical colleges · NHM MP · WHO

Drafted with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic); reviewed by the AIIMS Bhopal survey team.

Why this survey, and why it must be independent

What we measure

- The share of children aged 1–19 who swallowed albendazole on 6 or 9 October 2026
- Measured at the household, from the family, not from registers
- Compared with the coverage the district reported

Why it must be independent

- If the survey estimate is lower than reported, the reported figure is not validated
- Teachers, AWWs and ASHAs gave the tablets, so they must not be present when families answer
- Your neutral questions are the only thing that makes the result credible

You are not inspecting anyone. You are measuring, the same way in every household.

Your team and your forms

A team is a pair

- Both members segment, select households, interview and verify records
- Both phones are set up with the same team QR code
- Each member enters their own interviewer code
- In a cluster: segment and select together, then split the household list and interview in parallel
- Record verification needs both of you (two independent recounts)

Household form v0.6

One per selected household — Each phone

F4 Cluster control v1.1

One per cluster — Team lead’s phone

F10 Record verification v1.2

One per site: school and AWC — Either phone

Your day in one cluster

1

Before 8 am

Phones charged, forms updated, kit packed

2

Arrive

Meet the local guide; confirm the village or ward

3

Segment

Sketch map, make segments, draw one (F4)

4

Select

Number households, coin toss, List A or B

5

Interview

Every household on the list; revisit absentees

6

Verify

School and AWC registers (F10)

7

Close

Finish F4, send all forms, report to nodal officer

Plan for one cluster per day. Do not leave a cluster with households unvisited or revisits pending without telling the nodal officer.

Kit checklist

Phone

Charged, power bank, ODK set up, three forms downloaded

Letters

Your ID card and the authorization letter from NHM / medical college

Cluster list

Your assigned clusters for this phase (from the nodal officer)

List A / List B card

Laminated A4: coloured numbers are visited, grey ones skipped

Chalk and paper

To number doors and draw the sketch map

Lots

Numbered paper slips (1–30) to draw parts and segments

Sample tablet

Albendazole 400 mg chewable, to show every family

Statements

Printed consent and assent statements (Hindi)

Getting the phone ready

One-time setup, downloading forms, updating them

Phone checklist before leaving

Battery

Full charge and a charged power bank

Location

GPS on, mode “High accuracy”

Date and time

Set to automatic

Storage

At least 1 GB free

ODK Collect

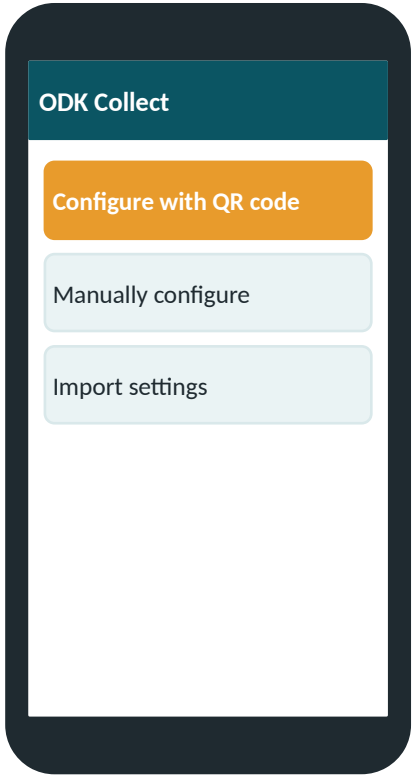
Connected to “NDD CES MP 2026”

Forms

Household v0.7, F4 v1.1, F10 v1.2 (or newer, as announced)

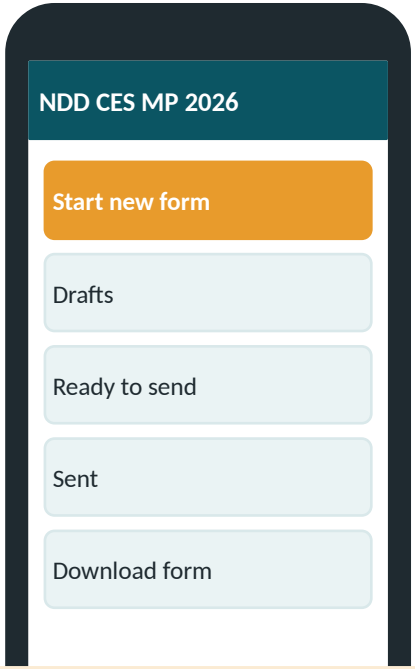
One-time setup: scan your team's QR code

1. Install "ODK Collect" (Get ODK Inc.) from the Play Store
2. Open it and tap "Configure with QR code"
3. Scan your team's code from the nodal officer, e.g. ratlam01 = team 1
4. Check the top bar shows "NDD CES MP 2026"
5. Both phones scan the same code; enter that team number in every form



Forms update automatically; check before you start

1. Connect to the internet each morning and open ODK Collect
2. New versions and the cluster list download by themselves
3. Open “Start new form”: you should see the household form, F4 and F10
4. Check the version in the form name (v0.7, v1.1, v1.2 or newer)
5. If a form is missing, tap “Download form”; if still missing, call the nodal officer



Phase 2 clusters arrive the same way: just connect in the morning; nothing else to install.

Training day and Diwali: practice entries

At training	Practise on your own team code: a few dummy households, one F4 and one F10, then send them
Before you leave	No drafts left, nothing waiting to send; the trainer checks your phone
Diwali break	No entries of any kind. Keep the phone set up; forms update by themselves
Before day 1	AIIMS deletes all practice data. Clear your Sent list: Delete saved form → Sent → select all
Day 1 onwards	Every form you send is survey data

Practice households use real cluster names. That is fine during training only; they are all deleted before the survey.

Arriving and segmenting the cluster

Form F4: find the cluster, make segments, draw one

Find the right village or ward

Do

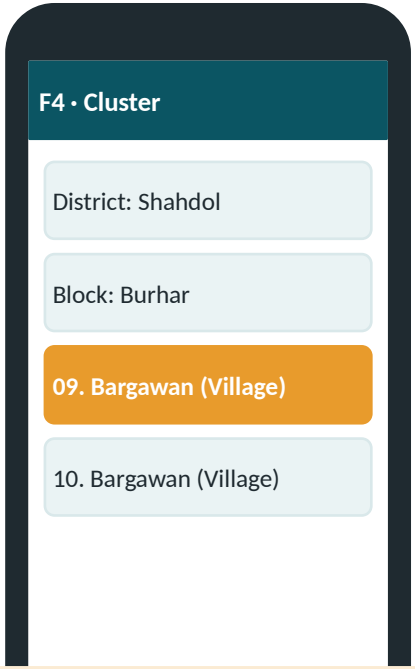
- Go to the village or ward named on your list, in the block named
- Ask the ASHA, AWW or panchayat secretary to walk you round as a guide
- Urban wards may have been renumbered since 2011: check the ward with the municipal office or ASHA
- Note the local name in F4 if it differs

Never

- Replace the cluster with a nearby or easier one
- Skip a hamlet (majra, tola) that belongs to the village
- Let the guide choose which part of the village to survey
- Start without calling the nodal officer if the unit cannot be found

Open F4: district, block, cluster

1. Start a new F4 for each cluster
2. Choose district, then block: only that block's 10 clusters appear
3. Choose your cluster by its number and name
4. Read the plan shown: 2011 households and planned segments, or "LARGE UNIT"
5. The household and F10 forms use the same three choices



Two clusters can share a name (e.g. Bargawan in Burhar). Always check the cluster number on your list.

Segmenting a normal unit (up to 600 households)

1. Walk round the whole unit with the guide; draw a sketch map with roads, lanes and landmarks
2. Read the planned number of segments in F4 (about 50 households each)
3. Divide the map into exactly that many parts with similar numbers of households, using clear boundaries
4. Number the segments on the map; write numbers on slips; ask the guide to draw one
5. Enter segments made and the segment drawn; photograph the map; record GPS at its centre

The number of segments comes from the plan. If you truly cannot make that many, F4 asks for the reason: call the nodal officer first.

Large unit (over 600 households): two steps

1	**Divide into parts**	Use roads or mohalla boundaries. F4 tells you how many parts (e.g. 12 for Amlai)
2	**Draw one part**	Slips in front of the guide; photograph the parts sketch
3	**Estimate households in that part**	Quick count with the ASHA or AWW, e.g. about 390
4	**Segment that part**	About 50 households each: F4 shows the number, e.g. 8
5	**Draw one segment**	Then number households and select as usual

24 clusters are large units, mostly town wards. F4 records parts × segments; this keeps the weights correct.

Selecting households: List A or List B

Number every household	In the drawn segment, chalk a number on each household door, 1, 2, 3 … following one route. A household = people who share a kitchen, not a building
Toss a coin	Heads: List A. Tails: List B. In front of the guide; record it in F4
Read the card	Visit the coloured numbers, skip the grey ones, up to your last number. The form refuses a grey number
Visit every listed household	Including those with no children: the form ends quickly for them

Never replace a household. A locked or refusing household gets its result code and you move on.

The household interview

Household form v0.7

How the form moves through a household

H1	H2–H3	H5	H6–H7	C	End
Identification and GPS	Result of visit, consent	Count and list children 1–19	Heard about NDD?	One section per child	Check, finalize

Swipe left to go forward, right to go back. The form skips questions that do not apply.

The highlighted step (counts and listing) is where most errors happen.

H1 Identification: check it at every household

Carried over from your last form

- District, block and cluster
- Team, interviewer and sampler codes
- Language, segment number, List A or B
- Confirm each one; change them when you move to a new cluster

Enter fresh every time

- Household number: the chalk number on the door; it must be on your list (A or B)
- GPS at the door; wait for accuracy of 10 m or better
- Check the household ID on screen, e.g. 434-098-0810-024 (cluster code + household number)

H2–H3 Result of visit and consent

1	Completed	Interview goes on
2	No member aged 1–19 years	Form ends
3	Household away for a long period	Form ends
4	No competent adult after a revisit	Revisit first
5	Refused	Form ends
6	Dwelling vacant or not found	Form ends

Rules

- Never replace a household
- Revisit absent households once, later the same day, before leaving
- Read the consent statement word for word
- Code 7 Other: write what happened

H5 Counts: read the probe, then count slowly

पढ़कर सुनाएँ: "कृपया एक वर्ष से बड़े बच्चों, रिश्तेदारों के यहाँ रह रहे बच्चों, और छात्रावास में रहने वाले पर यहीं के सामान्य निवासी बच्चों को भी शामिल करें।"

H5a

6–9 अक्टूबर 2026 के दौरान यहाँ कितने सामान्य निवासी (सभी उम्र के) रहते थे, जिनमें आज अनुपस्थित लोग भी शामिल हैं?

All usual residents during 6–9 October

H5b

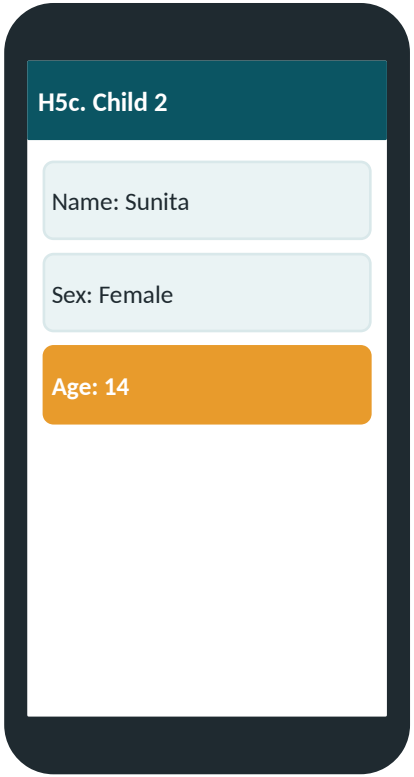
इनमें से कितने 1–19 वर्ष के बच्चे हैं?

Children aged 1–19. Babies under 1 are NOT counted

A child missed here is never interviewed. Probe for children away at relatives or hostels.

H5c Listing the children

1. The form opens one entry for each child counted in H5b
2. Enter first name, sex and age in completed years
3. Only ages 1–19 are accepted
4. If the number listed does not match H5b, a red message stops you
5. Found a baby under 1 while listing? Go back and reduce H5b



Who answers for each child

Child aged 10 or more, at home	The child answers. Read the assent statement first (C1a, up to age 17)
Child under 10	Parent or main caregiver answers
Child away today	Revisit later the same day, or phone; otherwise an adult of the household answers
Nobody can answer	Choose “No one present can answer” only after a revisit or phone call; tell the nodal officer

Interview at the household only, without teachers, AWWs or ASHAs listening.

Child questions: show the tablet

C5 कृमि मुक्ति के दिनों (6–9 अक्टूबर) में, क्या [नाम] को स्कूल, आंगनवाड़ी या कहीं और यह गोली दी गई थी?
C6 क्या [नाम] ने गोली खाई (चबाकर, पीसकर या पूरी निगलकर)?

C2–C3	School or college enrolment and class; AWC registration if aged 5 or under
C7–C9	Where, which day, in front of a teacher or worker (only if swallowed)
C11–C12	Main reason not offered, or not swallowed
C13	Any problem after taking it (all that apply)

Hold up the sample albendazole tablet for C5. Make sure they are not thinking of the weekly iron tablet.

Interviewing well

Do

- Introduce yourselves and show your ID
- Read questions as written, in the family's language
- Wait for the answer; probe neutrally ("Anything else?")
- Thank the household; mark the door as done

Do not

- Let the ASHA, AWW or teacher stay during the interview
- Suggest answers or show surprise
- Tell families what the school or AWC records say
- Promise any benefit or service

Finishing the household

1. Check the summary (H8): number of children listed
2. Add a remark only if something unusual happened
3. If the screen says “selected for a back-check”, note the household ID for the nodal officer
4. Tick “Finalize” and save
5. Mark the door as done on your list; go to the next number

Save as draft only if you will return the same day. Drafts are not sent.

Record verification

Form F10 at the school and the anganwadi centre

Which sites, and when

Sites for each cluster

- The government school attended by most of the sampled children (you know this after the interviews)
- The anganwadi centre serving the drawn segment
- Write both names and codes in F4

At the site

- Go after the interviews, the same day if possible
- Show the authorization letter to the headteacher or AWW
- Ask for the NDD registers and the retained copy of the reporting form
- Do not ask about individual sampled children

F10 step by step

Site	School: UDISE+ code and classes run. AWC: AWC code
Recording	Deworming held on 6 and 9 October; how ticks were recorded; reporting form copy available (photo)
Each category	Register available with ticks? → enrolled → recount NDD (single ticks) and mop-up (double ticks)
Second recount	The other team member recounts the total independently, without seeing the first count
Reported figure	From the reporting form, or “NA / data not received”: never 0 for missing
Tablets	Received, used, in stock

F10 rules

No ticks, but a figure was reported	Record it. The form marks it “not verifiable”. Ask how the figure was arrived at and record the answer
VF outside 0.90–1.10	The form asks for an explanation: ask and record. Do not argue, judge or correct anything
Photos	Photograph the reporting form only, never the registers or children’s names
Missing register	Choose “not available”: do not reconstruct numbers from memory

Never tick, correct or sign any register, and never tell staff whether their figures “pass”.

Closing the day

Finish F4, send, report

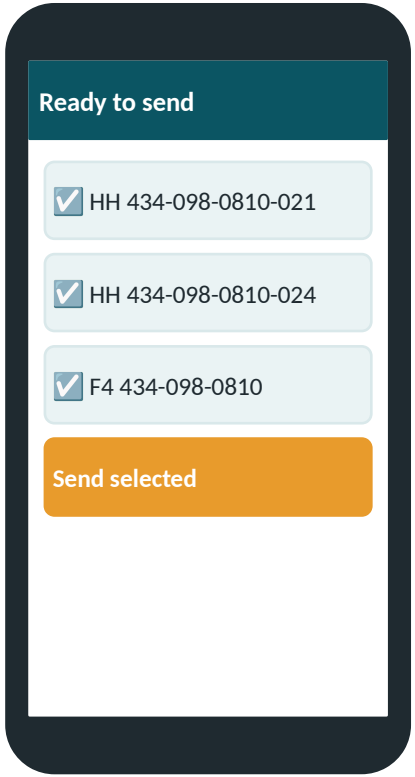
Finish F4 for the cluster

1. Enter the number of selected households under each result code
2. Check the total against the expected number F4 shows; explain a difference of more than 2
3. Enter children listed and child forms completed
4. Enter school and AWC names and codes
5. Finalize F4 when all revisits are done; the nodal officer reviews it

One F4 per cluster, filled by the team lead, finalized only when the cluster is complete.

Send every evening and report

1. Connect to mobile data or Wi-Fi
2. Open “Ready to send”, select all, tap “Send selected”
3. Check each form appears in “Sent”
4. Message the nodal officer: team, cluster, households completed, children, revisits pending
5. Never delete sent forms or uninstall ODK Collect



Common problems and what to do

Village or ward cannot be found	Call the nodal officer; never substitute
Unit much bigger or smaller than the plan	Follow F4; record the reason; call before changing segments
Form or cluster missing on the phone	Connect to the internet; tap “Download form”; then call
Red message, cannot go forward	Read it and correct the answer it points to
Wrong cluster or household number sent	Tell the nodal officer the household ID
Unsafe situation, hostility	Leave; inform the nodal officer; safety comes first

Golden rules

1 **Never replace**

A cluster, segment or household

2 **Draw in front of the guide**

Segments and List A/B by chance

3 **Number before selecting**

Every household in the segment

4 **Interview alone**

No worker listening

5 **Show the tablet**

At every child's C5

6 **Send every evening**

Keep all copies on the phone